names of the trustees. If investing in the company was not viable, they could take a call on what to do with the fund. Apart from this scheme, the trustees also called for donations to the Indian Navigation Scholarship Fund, meant to train youths in maritime technology.[105]

As the fervent appeals failed to elicit the needed response, SSNCo adopted what even the CID conceded was 'a somewhat novel method': the company began to sell 'donation tickets' for Re 1 and Rs 2.[106] As the price of a share was a substantial Rs 25 each, it was hoped that the general public without the necessary wherewithal would chip in with small sums. The police stated cynically that the object was not to restart the steamers but to repay a share to some shareholders. Whatever the wrangling within the company, there is no evidence of any director lining his pocket. Certainly, some deserted the company but the slur of dishonesty does not stick.[107]

In issuing these donation tickets, S.D. Krishna Aiyangar declared: 'Almost all houses in our Presidency can afford to take one or more tickets and as "Many a Mickle makes a Muckle" if only everybody that can afford will give.' Small, but prompt, donations would help to tide over the financial trouble. The following 'Conditions' appeared on the obverse side of the ticket under S.D. Krishna Aiyangar's signature:

> This sum of Rupees two (or one) has been received now as a donation to the Company, but if by similar collections and otherwise the Company is enabled to resume steamer service between Tuticorin and Colombo, then the pass will enable its bearer to a single free passage on board the Company's steamer from Tuticorin to Colombo or Colombo to Tuticorin, but in no case will the Company be liable to refund the Rupees two (or one) or any part thereof. This pass should be used within one year from the date when the said steamer service is resumed. This pass should be presented at the Company's office at Tuticorin or Colombo at least eight hours before the vessel in which the holder is to sail is timed to leave the harbour.[108]

The company fervently urged volunteers to take up the task of selling donation tickets.[109]

A desperate move, it was still welcomed by SSNCo's adherents. For instance, E. Suryanarayanaiyar of Thanjavur wrote to *India* welcoming the move to issue donation tickets.[110] Perhaps the last word may be given to the